

The voyages of Ohthere and Wulfstan

Translated and glossed by Tyler Lemon

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1 Text

- (1) a. **Ōhthere sǣ-d-e his hlāford-e, Ælfrēd-e cyning-e, þæt hē**
Ohthere.NOM say-PST-IND.3SG 3SG.M.GEN lord-DAT.SG Alfred-DAT.SG king-DAT.SG COMP 3SG.M.NOM
eal-ra Norð-monnan norþ-mest bū-d-e.
all-GEN.PL.STR north-man-GEN.PL north-most.ADV dwell-PST-SJV.SG
‘Ohthere said to his lord, King Alfred, that he lived the furthest north of all Norwegians.’
- b. **Hē cwæð þæt hē bū-d-e on þāem lande**
3SG.M.NOM say.PST-IND.3SG COMP 3SG.M.NOM dwell-PST-SJV.SG in DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N land-DAT.SG
norþ-weard-um wiþ þā West-sǣ.
north-ward-DAT.SG.N.STR against DET.DEF.ACC.SG.F west-sea.ACC.SG
‘He said that he lived in the northern part of the land by the West Sea (ocean west of Norway).’
- c. **Hē sǣ-d-e þēah þæt þæt land sīe swīþ-e**
3SG.M.NOM say-PST-IND.3SG though COMP DET.DEF.NOM.SG.N land.NOM.SG be.PRS.SJV.SG strong-ADV
lang norþ þonan, ac hit is eal
long.NOM.SG.N.STR north.ADV thence but 3SG.N.NOM be.PRS-IND.3SG all.NOM.SG.N
wēst-e, būton on fēaw-um stōw-um styccē-mæl-um
waste-NOM.SG.N.STR except in few-DAT.PL.STR place-DAT.PL piece-meal-DAT.PL
wīc-i-að Finn-as on hunt-oð-e on wintr-a and on sumer-a
camp-THM-PRS-IND.PL Finn-NOM.PL in hunt-NMLZ-DAT.SG in winter-DAT.SG and in summer-DAT.SG
on fisc-aþ-e be þære sǣ.
in fish-NMLZ-DAT.SG by DET.DEF.DAT.SG.F sea-DAT.SG
‘He said though that the land continues very long to the north from there, but it is all uninhabited, except in a few places here and there Finns (i.e. Sami) camp, hunting in winter and in summer fishing by the sea.’
- (2) a. **Hē sǣ-d-e þæt hē æt sum-um ċirr-e**
3SG.M.NOM say-PST-IND.3SG COMP 3SG.M.NOM at some-DAT.SG.M.STR occasion-DAT.SG
wol-d-e fand-i-an hū long-e þæt land norþ-ryht-e
want-PST-SJV.SG find.out-THM-INF how long-ADV DEM.DIST land.NOM.SG north-right-ADV
læġ-e, oþþe hwæðer ænig mon be-norð-an þāem
lie.PST-SJV.SG or whether any.NOM.SG.M.STR man.NOM.SG by-north-from DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N
wēstenn-e bū-d-e.
wasteland-DAT.SG dwell-PST-SJV.SG
‘He said that on one occasion he wanted to find out how far that land lay to the north, or whether anyone lived to the north of the wilderness.’
- b. **Þā fōr hē norþ-ryht-e be þāem land-e.**
then travel.PST-IND.3SG 3SG.M.NOM north-right-ADV by DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N land-DAT.SG
‘Then he traveled north near the land.’
- c. **Lēt him eal-ne weg þæt wēst-e**
let.PST-IND.3SG 3SG.M.DAT all-ACC.SG.M.STR way-ACC.SG DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N waste-ACC.SG.N.WK
land on ðæt stēor-bord and þā wīd-sǣ on
land.ACC.SG in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N steering-board.ACC.SG and DET.DEF.ACC.SG.F wide-sea.ACC.SG in

- ðæt bæc-bord þrīe dag-as; þā wæs hē swā
DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N back-board.ACC.SG three.ACC.M day-ACC.PL then be.PST.IND.3SG 3SG.M.NOM as
feor norþ swā þā hwæl-hunt-an firr-est far-aþ.
far.ADV north.ADV as DET.DEF.NOM.PL whale-hunt-AGT.NOM.PL.M far-SUP.ADV travel-PRS.IND.PL
‘The whole way he kept the empty land to his starboard and the open sea to his port side for three days;
then he was as far north as the whale hunters travel at the farthest.’
- d. Þā fōr hē þā ġiet norþ-ryht-e swā feor swā hē
then travel.PST.IND.3SG 3SG.M.NOM then yet north-right-ADV as far.ADV as 3SG.M.NOM
meah-t-e on þām oþr-um þri-m dag-um ġe-siġl-an.
can-PST-IND.3SG in DET.DEF.DAT.PL other-DAT.PL.STR three-DAT day-DAT.PL PFX-sail-INF
‘Then he traveled still northwards as far as he could sail in the next three days.’
- e. Þā bēag þæt land þær ēast-ryht-e, oþþe sēo
then turn.PST.IND.3SG DET.DEF.NOM.SG.N land.NOM.SG there east-right-ADV or DET.DEF.NOM.SG.F
sēo in on ðæt lond, hē n-yss-e hwæðer,
sea.NOM.SG in in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N land.ACC.SG 3SG.M.NOM NEG-know.PST-IND.3SG whether
būton hē wiss-e ðæt hē ðær bād
except 3SG.M.NOM know.PST-IND.3SG COMP 3SG.M.NOM there wait.PST.IND.3SG
west-an-wind-es and hwōn norþ-an and siġl-d-e ðā ēast be land-e
west-from-wind-GEN.SG and a.little north-from and sail-PST-IND.3SG then east.ADV by land-DAT.SG
swā swā hē meah-t-e on fēower dag-um ġe-siġl-an.
as as 3SG.M.NOM can-PST-IND.3SG in four day-DAT.PL PFX-sail-INF
‘Then the land turned eastwards, or the sea turned into the land, he did not know which, but he knew
that he waited there for wind from the west and a little from the north and then sailed east by land as
far as he could sail in four days.’
- f. Þā sçeol-d-e hē ðær bīd-an ryht-norþ-an-wind-es, for
then have.to-PST-IND.3SG 3SG.M.NOM there wait-INF right-north-from-wind-GEN.SG for
ðām þæt land bēag þær sūþ-ryht-e, oþþe
DEM.DIST.DAT.SG.N DET.DEF.NOM.SG.N land.NOM.SG turn.PST.IND.3SG there south-right-ADV or
sēo sēo in on ðæt land, hē
DET.DEF.NOM.SG.F sea.NOM.SG in in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N land.ACC.SG 3SG.M.NOM
n-yss-e hwæþer.
NEG-know.PST-IND.3SG whether
‘Then he had to wait there for a wind from due north, because the land turned south there, or the sea
turned into the land, he did not know which.’
- g. Þā siġl-d-e hē þonan sūð-ryht-e be land-e swā swā hē
then sail-PST-IND.3SG 3SG.M.NOM thence south-right-ADV by land-DAT.SG as as 3SG.M.NOM
meh-t-e on fīf dag-um ġe-siġl-an.
can-PST-IND.3SG in five day-DAT.PL PFX-sail-INF
‘Then he sailed southwards from there near land as far as he could sail in five days.’
- h. Ðā læġ þær ān miċel ēa ūp in on
then lie.PST.IND.3SG there one.NOM.SG.F large.NOM.SG.F.STR river.NOM.SG up in in
þæt land.
DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N land.ACC.SG
‘There a large river led up into the land.’
- i. Þā ċir-d-on hīe ūp in on ðā ēa, for þām
then turn-PST-IND.PL 3PL.NOM up in in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.F river.ACC.SG for DEM.DIST.DAT.SG.N
hīe ne dors-t-on forþ bī þære ēa siġl-an for
3PL.NOM NEG dare-PST-IND.PL forth.ADV by DET.DEF.DAT.SG.F river.DAT.SG sail-INF for
un-friþ-e, for þām ðæt land wæs
un-peace-DAT.SG for DEM.DIST.DAT.SG.N DET.DEF.NOM.SG.N land.NOM.SG be.PST.IND.3SG
eall ġe-bū-n on oþre healf-e þære
all.NOM.SG.N PFX-dwell-PART.NOM.SG.N.STR in other-ACC.SG.F.STR side-ACC.SG DET.DEF.GEN.SG.F
ēa-s.
river-GEN.SG

‘Then they turned up into the river, because they did not dare sail forth by the river for fear of hostility, because the land was all settled on the other side of the river.’

- j. **Ne mēt-t-e hē ær n-ān ġe-bū-n**
 NEG meet-PST-IND.3SG 3SG.M.NOM before NEG-one.ACC.SG.N PFX-dwell-PART.ACC.SG.N.STR
land sipþan hē from his āgn-um hām fōr,
 land.ACC.SG after 3SG.M.NOM from 3SG.M.GEN own-DAT.SG.M.STR home.DAT.SG travel.PST-IND.3SG
ac him wæs eal-ne weġ wēst-e land on
 but 3SG.M.DAT be.PST-IND.3SG all-ACC.SG.M.STR way.ACC.SG waste-NOM.SG.N.STR land.NOM.SG in
þæt stēor-bord, būtan fisċ-er-um and fugel-er-um and
 DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N steering-board.ACC.SG except fish-AGT.M-DAT.PL and fowl-AGT.M-DAT.PL and
hunt-um, and þæt wær-on eall Finn-as, and
 hunt-AGT.DAT.PL.M and DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.N be.PST-IND.PL all.NOM.SG.N Finn-NOM.PL and
him wæs ā wīd-sæ on ðæt bæc-bord.
 3SG.M.DAT be.PST-IND.3SG always wide-sea.NOM.SG in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N back-board.ACC.SG

‘He had not encountered any settled land before since he traveled from his own home, but the whole way there there had been empty land to his starboard except for fishermen and fowlers and hunters, and they were all Finns, and open sea was always to his port side.’

- (3) a. **Ðā Beorm-as hæf-d-on swīþ-e wel ġe-bū-d**
 DET.DEF.NOM.PL Bjarmian-NOM.PL have-PST-IND.PL strong-ADV well PFX-dwell-PART.ACC.SG.N.STR
hira land, ac hīe ne dors-t-on þær-on cum-an.
 3PL.GEN land.ACC.SG but 3PL.NOM NEG dare-PST-IND.PL there-in come-INF
 ‘The Bjarmians (Permians?, Komi?) had very widely cultivated their land, but they (Ohthere and his crew) did not dare go there.’
- b. **Ac þāra Ter-finn-a land wæs eal wēst-e,**
 but DET.DEF.GEN.PL Ter-Finn-GEN.PL land.NOM.SG be.PST-IND.3SG all.NOM.SG.N waste-NOM.SG.N.STR
būton ðær hunt-an ġe-wīc-o-d-on opþe fisċ-er-as opþe
 except there hunt-AGT.NOM.PL.M PFX-camp-THM-PST-IND.PL or fish-AGT.M-NOM.PL or
fugel-er-as.
 fowl-AGT.M-NOM.PL
 ‘But the land of the Terfinns (Ter-Sami?) was all uninhabited, except where hunters camped, or fishermen or fowlers.’
- c. **Fela spell-a him sǣ-d-on þā Beorm-as æġþer ġe of**
 many story-GEN.PL 3SG.M.DAT say-PST-IND.PL DET.DEF.NOM.PL Bjarmian-NOM.PL each and from
hiera āgn-um land-e ġe of þām land-um þe ymb hīe
 3PL.GEN own-DAT.SG.N.STR land-DAT.SG and from DET.DEF.DAT.PL land-DAT.PL REL around 3PL.ACC
ūt-an wær-on, ac hē n-ys-t-e hwæt þæs
 out-from be.PST-IND.PL but 3SG.M.NOM NEG-know-PST-IND.3SG what.ACC DET.DEF.GEN.SG.N
sōþ-es wæs, for þām hē hit self ne
 truth-GEN.SG be.PST-IND.3SG for DEM.DIST.DAT.SG.N 3SG.M.NOM 3SG.N.ACC self.NOM.SG.M.STR NEG
ġe-seah.
 PFX-see.PST-IND.3SG
 ‘Many stories the Bjarmians told him both about their own land and about the lands that were around them, but he did not know how much was true, because he did not see it himself.’
- d. **Ðā Finn-as, him þūh-t-e, and þā Beorm-as**
 DET.DEF.NOM.PL Finn-NOM.PL 3SG.M.DAT seem-PST-IND.3SG and DET.DEF.NOM.PL Bjarmian-NOM.PL
spræc-on nēah ān ġe-þeod-e.
 speak-PST-IND.PL near.ADV one.ACC.SG.N PFX-language-ACC.SG
 ‘The Finns, it seemed to him, and the Bjarmians spoke almost the same language.’
- e. **Swīþ-ost hē fōr ðider, tō-ēac-an þæs land-es**
 strong-SUP.ADV 3SG.M.NOM travel.PST-IND.3SG to.there to-eke-DAT.SG DET.DEF.GEN.SG.N land-GEN.SG
sċēaw-ung-e, for þām hors-hwæl-um, for ðām hīe
 show-NMLZ-DAT.SG for DET.DEF.DAT.PL horse-whale-DAT.PL for DEM.DIST.DAT.SG.N 3PL.NOM
habb-að swīþ-e æpel-e bān on hiora tōþ-um (
 have-PRS-IND.PL strong-ADV noble-ACC.SG.N.STR bone.ACC.SG in 3PL.GEN tooth-DAT.PL (

pā **tēð** **hīe** **brōh-t-on** **sum-e** **pāem**
 DET.DEF.ACC.PL tooth.ACC.PL 3PL.NOM bring-PST-IND.PL some-ACC.PL.M.STR DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M
cyning-e), and **hiora** **hȳd** **bi-ð** **swīð-e** **gōd** **tō**
 king-DAT.SG) and 3PL.GEN hide.NOM.SG be.HAB-IND.3SG strong-ADV good.NOM.SG.F.STR to
scīp-rāp-um.
 ship-rope-DAT.PL

‘He traveled there mostly, in addition to the exploration of the land, for the walruses, because they have very fine bone in their teeth (the teeth they brought some of for the king), and their hide is very good for ships’ ropes.’

- f. **Sē** **hwæl** **bi-ð** **micl-e** **læss-a** **þonne**
 DET.DEF.NOM.SG.M whale.NOM.SG be.HAB-IND.3SG large-ADV little.CMP-NOM.SG.M.WK than
ōðre **hwal-as:** **ne** **bi-ð** **hē** **leng-r-a** **ðonne**
 other-NOM.PL.M.STR whale-NOM.PL NEG be.HAB-IND.3SG 3SG.M.NOM long-CMP-NOM.SG.M.WK than
syfan eln-a **lang.**
 seven ell-GEN.PL long.NOM.SG.M.STR

‘This whale is much smaller than other whales: it is not longer than 7 ells (~14 feet) long.’

- g. **Ac on his** **āgn-um** **land-e** **is** **sē**
 but in 3SG.M.GEN own-DAT.SG.N.STR land.DAT.SG be.PRS.IND.3SG DET.DEF.NOM.SG.M
bet-st-a **hwæl-hunt-að:** **pā** **bēo-ð** **eahta and**
 good-SUP-NOM.SG.M.WK whale-hunt-NMLZ.NOM.SG DEM.DIST.NOM.PL be.HAB-IND.PL eight and
fēower-tig-es eln-a **lang-e,** **and pā** **mæ-st-an**
 four-ty-GEN.SG ell-GEN.PL long-NOM.PL.M.STR and DET.DEF.NOM.PL large-SUP-NOM.PL.M.WK
fif-tig-es eln-a **lang-e.**
 five-ty-GEN.SG ell-GEN.PL long-NOM.PL.M.STR

‘But in his own land is the best whale hunting: those (whales) are 48 ells long and the biggest 50 ells long.’

- h. **Þāra** **hē** **sæ-d-e** **þæt hē** **syx-a** **sum**
 DEM.DIST.GEN.PL 3SG.M.NOM say-PST-IND.3SG COMP 3SG.M.NOM six-GEN.PL some.NOM.SG.M
of-slōg-e **syx-tig on twā-m** **dag-um.**
 from-slay.PST-SJV.SG six-ty in two-DAT day-DAT.PL

‘Of these (whales), he said that he as part of a crew of 6 (whalers) killed 60 in two days.’

- (4) a. **Hē** **wæs** **swyð-e** **spēd-ig** **man** **on pām**
 3SG.M.NOM be.PST.IND.3SG strong-ADV wealth-ADJ.NOM.SG.M.STR man.NOM.SG in DET.DEF.DAT.PL
æht-um **þe heora** **spēd-a** **on bēo-ð,** **þæt**
 possession-DAT.PL REL 3PL.GEN wealth-NOM.PL in be.HAB-IND.PL DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.N
is **on wil-dr-um.**
 be.PRS.IND.3SG in wild.beast-DAT.PL

‘He was a very wealthy man in the possessions that their wealth is based on, which is wild beasts.’

- b. **Hē** **hæf-d-e** **pā** **gýt, ðā** **hē** **þone** **cyningc**
 3SG.M.NOM have-PST-IND.3SG then yet then 3SG.M.NOM DET.DEF.ACC.SG.M king.ACC.SG
sōh-t-e, **tamr-a** **dēor-a** **un-be-boh-t-ra** **syx hund**
 seek-PST-IND.3SG tame-GEN.PL.STR animal-GEN.PL un-by-buy-PART-GEN.PL.STR six hundred.ACC.PL
 ‘He still had, when he visited the king, 600 unsold tame animals.’

- c. **Þā** **dēor** **hī** **hāt-að** **hrān-as;** **þāra**
 DET.DEF.ACC.PL animal.ACC.PL 3PL.NOM call-PRS.IND.PL reindeer-ACC.PL DEM.DIST.GEN.PL
wær-on **syx stæl-hrān-as,** **ðā** **bēo-ð** **swyð-e**
 be.PST-IND.PL six decoy-reindeer-NOM.PL DEM.DIST.NOM.PL be.HAB-IND.PL strong-ADV
dȳr-e **mid Finn-um,** **for ðæm** **hȳ** **fō-ð**
 dear-NOM.PL.M.STR with Finn-DAT.PL for DEM.DIST.DAT.SG.N 3PL.NOM catch-PRS.IND.PL
pā **wild-an** **hrān-as** **mid.**
 DET.DEF.ACC.PL wild-ACC.PL.WK reindeer-ACC.PL with

‘Those animals they call reindeer; of these, 6 were decoy reindeer, which are very valuable to the Finns, because they catch the wild reindeer with them.’

- d. **Hē** **wæs** **mid þām** **fyrst-um** **mann-um** **on þām**
 3SG.M.NOM be.PST-IND.3SG with DET.DEF.DAT.PL first-DAT.PL.WK man-DAT.PL in DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N
land-e; **n-æf-d-e** **hē** **þēah mā** **ðonne twēn-tiġ hryðer-a**
 land-DAT.SG NEG-have-PST-IND.3SG 3SG.M.NOM though large.COMP.ADV than two-ty cow-GEN.PL
and twēn-tiġ sċeap-a **and twēn-tiġ swȳn-a,** **and þæt** **lȳtl-e**
 and two-ty sheep-GEN.PL and two-ty swine-GEN.PL and DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N little-ACC.SG.M.WK
þæt **hē** **ere-d-e** **hē** **ere-d-e** **mid**
 DEM.DIST.ACC.SG.N 3SG.M.NOM plough-PST-IND.3SG 3SG.M.NOM plough-PST-IND.3SG with
hors-an.
 horse-DAT.PL
 ‘He was among the principal men in that land, though he did not have more than 20 cows and 20 sheep
 and 20 swine, and the little (land) that he ploughed, he ploughed with horses.’
- e. **Ac hyra** **ār** **is** **māe-st** **on þām** **gafol-e** **þe**
 but 3PL.GEN income.NOM.SG be.PRS-IND.3SG large-SUP.ADV in DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N tribute-DAT.SG REL
ðā **Finn-as** **him** **ġyld-að.**
 DET.DEF.NOM.PL Finn-NOM.PL 3PL.DAT pay-PRS-IND.PL
 ‘But their income is mostly from the tribute that the Finns pay to them.’
- f. **Þæt** **gafol** **bi-ð** **on dēor-a** **fell-um** **and on**
 DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N tribute.NOM.SG be.HAB-IND.3SG in animal-GEN.PL skin-DAT.PL and in
fugel-a **feðer-um** **and hwal-es** **bān-e** **and on þām**
 fowl-GEN.PL feather-DAT.PL and whale-GEN.SG bone-DAT.SG and in DET.DEF.DAT.PL
sċip-rāp-um **þe bēo-ð** **of hwæl-es** **hȳd-e** **ġe-worh-t**
 ship-rope-DAT.PL REL be.HAB-IND.PL from whale-GEN.SG hide-DAT.SG PFX-make-PART.NOM.SG.N.STR
and of **sēol-es.**
 and from seal-GEN.SG
 ‘The tribute consists of animal skins and bird feathers and whale bone and the ships’ ropes that are made
 from whale and seal hides.’
- g. **Æġhwilċ** **ġyld** **be hys** **ġe-byrd-um.**
 every.NOM.SG.M.STR pay-PRS-IND.3SG by 3SG.M.GEN PFX-birth-DAT.PL
 ‘Each pays according to his rank.’
- h. **Sē** **byrd-est-a** **sċeall** **ġyld-an** **fif-tȳne mearð-es**
 DET.DEF.NOM.SG.M birth-SUP-NOM.SG.M.WK have.to.PRS-IND.3SG pay-INF five-teen marten-GEN.SG
fell **and fif hrān-es** **and ān** **ber-an** **fel** **and tȳn**
 skin.ACC.PL and five reindeer-GEN.SG and one.ACC.SG.N bear-GEN.SG skin.ACC.SG and ten
ambr-a **feðr-a** **and ber-en-ne** **kyrtel** **oððe**
 amber-GEN.PL feather-GEN.PL and bear-ADJ-ACC.SG.M.STR coat.ACC.SG or
yter-en-ne **and twēgen** **sċip-rāp-as;** **æġþer sȳ** **syx-tiġ eln-a**
 otter-ADJ-ACC.SG.M.STR and two.ACC.M ship-rope-ACC.PL each be.PRS.SJV.SG six-ty ell-GEN.PL
lang; **ōþer** **sȳ** **of hwæl-es** **hȳd-e**
 long.NOM.SG.M.STR other.NOM.SG.M.STR be.PRS.SJV.SG from whale-GEN.SG hide-DAT.SG
ġe-worh-t, **ōþer** **of sīol-es.**
 PFX-make-PART.NOM.SG.M.STR other.NOM.SG.M.STR from seal-GEN.SG
 ‘The highest ranking have to pay 15 marten skins and 5 reindeer skins and 1 bear skin and 10 ambers
 (unit of measurement) of feathers and a bear-skin or otter-skin coat and 2 ships’ ropes; each is 60 ells
 long: one is made from whale skin, and the other from seal skin.’
- (5) a. **Hē** **sāe-d-e** **ðæt** **Norð-mann-a** **land** **wær-e** **swȳþ-e**
 3SG.M.NOM say-PST-IND.3SG COMP north-man-GEN.PL land.NOM.SG be.PST-SJV.SG strong-ADV
lang **and swȳð-e** **smæl.**
 long.NOM.SG.N.STR and strong-ADV narrow.NOM.SG.N.STR
 ‘He said that the Norwegians’ land is very long and very narrow.’
- b. **Eal** **þæt** **his** **man** **āþer** **oððe ett-an** **oððe eri-an**
 all.NOM.SG.N.STR DEM.DIST.ACC.SG.N 3SG.N.GEN one-INDF either or graze-INF or plough-INF

mæg, **þæt** **lī-ð** **wið** **ðā** **sā;** **and**
 can.PRS.IND.3SG DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.N lie-PRS.IND.3SG against DET.DEF.ACC.SG.F sea.ACC.SG and
þæt **is** **þēah** **on sum-um** **stōw-um** **swyð-e**
 DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.N be.PRS.IND.3SG though in some-DAT.PL.STR place-DAT.PL strong-ADV
clūd-iġ.

rock-ADJ.NOM.SG.N.STR

‘All that one can either graze or plow of it, that lies by the sea, and even that is very rocky in some places.’

- c. **And liġ-að** **wild-e** **mōr-as** **wið-ēast-an** **and wið-upp-on,**
 and lie-PRS.IND.PL wild-NOM.PL.M.STR moor-NOM.PL agaisnt-east-from and against-up-in
emn-lang-e **þām** **bȳ-n-um** **land-e;** **on þām**
 even-long-ADV DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N dwell-PART-DAT.SG.N.STR land-DAT.SG in DET.DEF.DAT.PL
mōr-um **eard-i-að** **Finn-as.**
 moor-DAT.PL live-THM-PRS.IND.PL Finn-NOM.PL

‘And wild moors lie to the east and above, along the settled land; in the moors live Finns.’

- d. **And þæt** **bȳ-n-e** **land** **is** **ēaste-weard**
 and DET.DEF.NOM.SG.N dwell-PART-NOM.SG.N.WK land.NOM.SG be.PRS.IND.3SG east-ward
brād-ost **and symle swā norð-or** **swā smæl-r-e.**
 broad-SUP.NOM.SG.N.STR and always as north-CMP.ADV as narrow-COMP-NOM.SG.N.WK

‘And the settled land is widest to the east and the further north (one goes) the narrower (it becomes).’

- e. **Ēaste-werd hit** **mæg** **bīo-n** **syx-tiġ mīl-a** **brād** **oppe**
 east-ward 3SG.N.NOM can.PRS.IND.3SG be.HAB-INF six-ty mile-GEN.PL broad.NOM.SG.N.STR or
hwēne brād-r-e; **and midde-weard þrī-tiġ oððe brād-r-e.**
 a.little broad-CMP-NOM.SG.N.WK and middle-ward three-ty or broad-COMP-NOM.SG.N.WK

‘Eastward it can be 60 miles wide, or a little wider, and in the middle it can be 30 (miles) or wider.’

- f. **And norðe-weard, hē** **cwæð,** **þær hit** **smal-ost**
 and north-ward 3SG.M.NOM say.PST.IND.3SG there 3SG.N.NOM narrow-SUP.NOM.SG.N.STR
wær-e, **þæt hit** **mih-t-e** **bēo-n** **þrēo-ra mīl-a**
 be.PST-SJV.SG COMP 3SG.N.NOM can-PST-IND.3SG be.HAB-INF three-GEN mile-GEN.PL
brād **tō þām** **mōr-e,** **and sē** **mōr**
 broad.NOM.SG.N.STR to DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M moor-DAT.SG and DET.DEF.NOM.SG.M moor.NOM.SG
syðþan **on sum-um** **stōw-um** **swā brād** **swā man**
 afterwards in some-DAT.PL.STR place-DAT.PL as broad.NOM.SG.M.STR as one.INDF
mæg **on twā-m wuc-um** **ofer-fēr-an,** **and on sum-um** **stōw-um** **swā**
 can.PRS.IND.3SG in two-DAT week-DAT.PL over-travel-INF and in some-DAT.PL.STR place-DAT.PL as
brād **swā man** **mæg** **on syx dag-um** **ofer-fēr-an.**
 broad.NOM.SG.M.STR as one.INDF can.PRS.IND.3SG in six day-DAT.PL over-travel-INF

‘And northward, he said, where it is narrowest, that it could be three miles wide to the moor, and the moor afterwards is as wide in some places as one can travel over in two weeks, and in some places as wide as one can travel over in six days.’

- g. **Ðonne is** **tō-emn-es** **þām** **land-e**
 then be.PRS.IND.3SG to-even-GEN.SG.N.STR DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N land-DAT.SG
sūðe-weard-um, **on oðr-e** **healf-e** **þæs** **mōr-es,**
 south-ward-DAT.SG.N.STR in other-ACC.SG.F.STR side-ACC.SG DET.DEF.GEN.SG.M moor-GEN.SG
Swēo-land, op **þæt** **land** **norðe-weard;** **and**
 Swede-land until DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N land.ACC.SG north-ward.ACC.SG.N.STR and
tō-emn-es **þām** **land-e** **norðe-weard-um** **Cwēn-a**
 to-even-GEN.SG.N.STR DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N land-DAT.SG north-ward-DAT.SG.N.STR Kven-GEN.PL
land.
 land.NOM.SG

‘Then along the southern part of the land (Norway), on the other side of the moor, is Sweden, until the northern part of the land; and along the northern part of the land is Cwen (Kven) land.’

- h. **Þā** **Cwēn-as** **herġ-i-að** **hwīl-um** **on ðā**
 DET.DEF.NOM.PL Kven-NOM.PL harry-THM-PRS.IND.PL time-DAT.PL in DET.DEF.ACC.PL

Norð-men ofer ðone mōr, hwīl-um þā
north-man.ACC.PL over DET.DEF.ACC.SG.M moor.ACC.SG time-DAT.PL DET.DEF.NOM.PL
Norð-men on h̄y.
north-man.NOM.PL in 3PL.ACC

‘The Cwens sometimes raid the Norwegians across the moor, sometimes the Norwegians raid them.’

- i. **And þær sint swīð-e micl-e mer-as fersc̣-e g̣eond**
and there be.PRS.IND.PL strong-ADV large-NOM.PL.M.STR lake-NOM.PL fresh-NOM.PL.M.STR through
þā mōr-as, and ber-að þā Cwēn-as hyra
DET.DEF.ACC.PL moor-ACC.PL and bear-PRS.IND.PL DET.DEF.NOM.PL Kven-NOM.PL 3PL.GEN
ṣcyp-u ofer land on ðā mer-as and þanon herg-i-að on
ship-ACC.PL over land.ACC.SG in DET.DEF.ACC.PL lake-ACC.PL and thence harry-THM-PRS.IND.PL in
ðā Norð-men; h̄y habb-að swyð-e ḷytl-e
DET.DEF.ACC.PL north-man.ACC.PL 3PL.NOM have-PRS.IND.PL strong-ADV little-ACC.PL.N.STR
ṣcypa and swyðe ḷeoht-e.
ship-ACC.PL and strong-ADV light-ACC.PL.N.STR

‘And there are very large freshwater lakes throughout the moors, and the Cwens carry their ships over land to the lakes and from there raid the Norwegians; they have very small and very light ships.’

- (6) a. **Ōthere ṣæ-d-e þæt ṣiō sc̣īr hāt-te**
Othere.NOM say-PST-IND.3SG COMP DET.DEF.NOM.SG.F shire.NOM.SG call-PASS.PRS.IND.3SG
Hālgoland þe h̄e on bū-d-e.
Håloga-land.NOM REL 3SG.M.NOM in dwell-PST-IND.3SG
‘Ohthere said that the district that he lived in is called Hålogaland.’
- b. **H̄e cwæð þæt n-ān man ne bū-d-e be-norð-an**
3SG.M.NOM say.PST.IND.3SG COMP NEG-one.NOM.SG.M one.INDF NEG dwell-PST-SJV.SG by-north-from
him.
3SG.M.DAT
‘He said that no one lived to the north of him.’
- c. **Ponne is ān port on sūðe-weard-um þæm**
then be.PRS.IND.3SG one.NOM.SG.M port.NOM.SG in south-ward-DAT.SG.N.STR DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N
land-e þone man h̄æt Sc̣īringesheal.
land-DAT.SG DEM.DIST.ACC.SG.M one.INDF call.PRS.IND.3SG Skiringssal.ACC.SG
‘Then in the south of the land is a port that one calls Skiringssal.’
- d. **Pyder h̄e cwæð þæt man ne mih-t-e g̣e-segl-i-an on**
to.there 3SG.M.NOM say.PST.IND.3SG COMP one.INDF NEG can-PST-IND.3SG PFX-sail-THM-INF in
ān-um mōnð-e g̣yf man on niht wīc-o-d-e and
one-DAT.SG.M month-DAT.SG if one.INDF in night.ACC.SG camp-THM-PST-IND.3SG and
æḷc-e dæg-e hæf-d-e ambyr-ne wind.
every-INS.SG.M.STR day-DAT.SG have-PST-IND.3SG favorable-ACC.SG.M.STR wind.ACC.SG
‘He said that one could not sail there in one month if they camped at night and had favorable wind every day.’
- e. **And eall-e ðā hwīl-e h̄e ṣceal segl-i-an**
and all-ACC.SG.F.STR DET.DEF.ACC.SG.F time-ACC.SG 3SG.M.NOM have.to.PRS.IND.3SG sail-THM-INF
be land-e.
by land-DAT.SG
‘And all the while he must sail by land.’
- f. **And on þæt stēor-bord him bi-ð ær-est**
and in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N steering-board.ACC.SG 3SG.M.DAT be.HAB-IND.3SG before-SUP.ADV
Īr-a-land and þonne ðā īg-land þe synd
Irish-GEN.PL-land.NOM.SG and then DET.DEF.NOM.PL island-land.NOM.PL REL be.PRS.IND.PL
be-tux Īr-a-land-e and þiss-um land-e.
by-twofold Irish-GEN.PL-land-DAT.SG and DEM.PROX-DAT.SG.N land-DAT.SG
‘And to his starboard first there is Ireland and then the islands that are between Ireland (Shetlands, Orkneys, Hebrides?) and this land (Britain).’

- g. **Ponne is þis land (on þæt**
 then be.PRS.IND.3SG DEM.PROX.NOM.SG.N land.NOM.SG (in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N
stēor-bord) oð hē cym-ð tō Sćīringesheal-e, and
 steering-board.ACC.SG) until 3SG.M.NOM come-PRS.IND.3SG to Skiringssal-DAT.SG and
eal-ne weġ on þæt bæc-bord Nord-weġ.
 all-ACC.SG.M.STR way.ACC.SG in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N back-board.ACC.SG north-way.NOM.SG
 ‘Then there is this land (to the starboard)¹ until he comes to Skiringssal, and the whole way to the port side is Norway.’

- (7) a. **Wið-sūð-an þone Sćīringesheal fyl-ð swyð-e**
 against-south-from DET.DEF.ACC.SG.M Skiringssal.ACC.SG fall-PRS.IND.3SG strong-ADV
myċel sǣ ūp in on ðæt lond; sēo
 large.NOM.SG.F.STR sea.NOM.SG up in in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N land.ACC.SG DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.F
is brād-r-e þonne æniġ man ofer-sēo-n
 be.PRS.IND.3SG broad-COMP-NOM.SG.F.WK than any.NOM.SG.M.STR man.NOM.SG over-see-INF
mæg-e, and is Got-land on oðr-e healf-e on-ġēan
 can.PRS-SJV.SG and be.PRS.IND.3SG Jute-land.NOM.SG in other-ACC.SG.F.STR side-ACC.SG in-again
and siððan Sillende.
 and after Sillende.NOM.SG
 ‘South of Skiringssal a very large sea leads up into the land; it is wider than anyone can see over, and Jutland is opposite on the other side and then Sillende (an area of the Jutland peninsula south of what is being called Jutland here).’
- b. **Sēo sǣ lī-ð mæniġ hund mīl-a ūp**
 DET.DEF.NOM.SG.F sea.NOM.SG lie-PRS.IND.3SG many.ACC.PL.N.STR hundred.ACC.PL mile-GEN.PL up
in on þæt land.
 in in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N land.ACC.SG
 ‘The sea runs many hundred miles up into the land.’
- c. **And of Sćīringesheal-e hē cwæð þæt hē seġl-o-d-e on**
 and from Skiringssal-DAT.SG 3SG.M.NOM say.PST.IND.3SG COMP 3SG.M.NOM sail-THM-PST-SJV.SG in
fif dag-an tō þǣm port-e þe mon hǣt æt Hǣp-um;
 five day-DAT.PL to DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M port-DAT.SG REL one.INDF call.PRS.IND.3SG at Heath-DAT.PL
sē stent be-tuh Wined-um, and Seax-um, and
 DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.M stand.PRS.IND.3SG by-twofold Wend-DAT.PL and Saxon-DAT.PL and
Angl-e, and hȳr-ð in on Den-e.
 Angeln-DAT.SG and belong-PRS.IND.3SG in in Dane-ACC.PL
 ‘And from Skiringssal he said that he sailed in five days to the port that one calls Hedeby; it stands between the Wends (i.e. Slavs) and the Saxons and Angeln (the peninsula), and it belongs to the Danes.’
- d. **Ðā hē þider-weard seġl-o-d-e fram Sćīringesheal-e, þā wæs**
 then 3SG.M.NOM to.there-ward sail-THM-PST-IND.3SG from Skiringssal-DAT.SG then be.PST.IND.3SG
him on þæt bæc-bord Den-a-mearc, and on
 3SG.M.DAT in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N back-board.ACC.SG Dane-GEN.PL-mark.NOM.SG and in
þæt stēor-bord wīd-sǣ prȳ dag-as; and þā,
 DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N steering-board.ACC.SG wide-sea.NOM.SG three.ACC.M day-ACC.PL and then
twēgen dag-as ær hē tō Hǣp-um cōm-e, him
 two.ACC.M day-ACC.PL before 3SG.M.NOM to Heath-DAT.PL come.PST-SJV.SG 3SG.M.DAT
wæs on þæt stēor-bord Got-land, and Sillende,
 be.PST.IND.3SG in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N steering-board.ACC.SG Jute-land.NOM.SG and Sillende.NOM.SG
and īġ-land-a fela.
 and island-land-GEN.PL many
 ‘When he was sailing there from Skiringssal, on his port side was Denmark (now Halland and Skåne in Sweden), and on his starboard was open sea for three days; and then, for two days before he came to Hedeby, on his starboard were Jutland and Sillende and many islands.’

¹This prepositional phrase in parentheses is only present in some versions of the text.

- e. **On þām land-um eard-o-d-on Engl-e, ær hī hider on**
in DEM.DIST.DAT.PL land-DAT.PL live-THM-PST-IND.PL English-NOM.PL before 3PL.NOM to.here in
land cōm-an.
land.ACC.SG come-PST-IND.PL
‘In those lands lived the English, before they came here to (this) land.’
- f. **And hym wæs ðā twēgen dag-as on ðæt**
and 3SG.M.DAT be.PST-IND.3SG DEM.DIST.ACC.PL two.ACC.M day-ACC.PL in DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N
bæcbord þā īg-land þe in Den-e-mearc-e
back-board.ACC.SG DET.DEF.NOM.PL island-land.NOM.PL REL in Dane-NOM.PL-mark-ACC.SG
hȳr-að.
belong-PRS-IND.PL
‘And to his port side for those two days were the islands that belong to Denmark.’
- (8) a. **Wulfstān sǣ-d-e þæt hē ġe-fōr-e of Hæð-um, þæt**
Wulfstan.NOM.SG say-PST-IND.3SG COMP 3SG.M.NOM PFX-travel.PST-SJV.SG from Heath-DAT.PL COMP
hē wær-e on Truso on syfan dag-um and niht-um, þæt
3SG.M.NOM be.PST-SJV.SG in Truso.DAT.SG in seven day-DAT.PL and night-DAT.PL COMP
þæt scīp wæs eal-ne weġ yrn-ende under
DET.DEF.NOM.SG.N ship.NOM.SG be.PST-IND.3SG all-ACC.SG.M.STR way.ACC.SG run-PART-PRS under
seġl-e.
sail-DAT.SG
‘Wulfstan said that he traveled from Hedeby, that he was in Truso in seven days and nights, that the ship
was the whole way running under sail.’
- b. **Weonoð-land him wæs on stēor-bord, and on bæc-bord**
Wend-land 3SG.M.DAT be.PST-IND.3SG in steering-board.ACC.SG and in back-board.ACC.SG
him wæs Langa-land and Læ-land and Falster and
3SG.M.DAT be.PST-IND.3SG Long-land.NOM.SG and Lol-land.NOM.SG and Falster.NOM.SG and
Scōneġ; and þās land eall hȳr-að tō
Skåne.NOM.SG and DEM.PROX.NOM.PL land.NOM.PL all.NOM.PL.N.STR belong-PRS-IND.PL to
Den-e-mearc-an.
Dane-NOM.PL-mark-DAT.SG
‘Wendland was to his starboard, and to his port side were Langeland and Lolland and Falster and Skåne;
and these lands all belong to Denmark.’
- c. **And þonne Burgend-a land wæs ūs on bæc-bord, and**
and then Burgundian-GEN.PL land.NOM.SG be.PST-IND.3SG 1PL.DAT in back-board.ACC.SG and
þā habb-að him sylf cuning.
DEM.DIST.NOM.PL have-PRS-IND.PL 3PL.DAT self.NOM.PL.M.STR king.ACC.SG
‘And then Burgundy (Bornholm) was to the port side, and they have their own king.’
- d. **Þonne æfter Burgend-a land-e wær-on ūs þās**
then after Burgundian-GEN.PL land.DAT.SG be.PST-IND.PL 1PL.DAT DEM.PROX.NOM.PL
land þā synd hāt-en-e ær-est Blecinga
land.NOM.PL DEM.DIST.NOM.PL be.PRS-IND.PL call-PART-NOM.PL.N.STR before-SUP.ADV Blekinge
ēġ, and Meore and Eow-land and Got-land on bæc-bord; and
island.NOM.SG and Möre.NOM.SG and Ö-land.NOM.SG and Got-land in back-board.ACC.SG and
þās land hȳr-að tō Swēon.
DEM.PROX.NOM.PL land.NOM.PL belong-PRS-IND.PL to Swede.DAT.PL
‘Then after Burgundy, to our port side were these lands that are called first Blekinge island, and (then)
Möre and Öland and Gotland; and these lands begong to the Swedes.’
- e. **And Weonod-land wæs ūs eal-ne weġ on**
and Wend-land.NOM.SG be.PST-IND.3SG 1PL.DAT all-ACC.SG.M.STR way.ACC.SG in
stēor-bord oð Wīsl-e-mūð-an.
steering-board.ACC.SG until Vistula-NOM.SG-river.mouth-ACC.SG
‘And Wendland was to our starboard the whole way until the mouth of the Vistula.’

- (9) a. **Sēo** **Wīsl-e** **is** **swȳð-e** **myċel** **ēa,** **and**
 DET.DEF.NOM.SG.F Vistula-NOM.SG be.PRS.IND.3SG strong-ADV large.NOM.SG.F.STR river.NOM.SG and
hīo **tō-lī-ð** **Wit-land** **and Weonod-land,** **and þæt**
 3SG.F.NOM apart-lie-PRS.IND.3SG Wit-land.ACC.SG and Wend-land.ACC.SG and DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.N
Wit-land **be-limp-eð** **tō Ēst-um.**
 Wit-land.NOM.SG by-happen-PRS.IND.3SG to Est-DAT.PL
 ‘The Vistula is a very large river, and it separates Witland and Wendland, and that Witland belongs to the Ests.’
- b. **And sēo** **Wīsl-e** **lī-ð** **ūt of Weonod-land-e and**
 and DET.DEF.NOM.SG.F Vistula-NOM.SG lie-PRS.IND.3SG out from Wend-land-DAT.SG and
lī-ð **in Ēst-mer-e,** **and sē** **Ēst-mer-e** **is** **hūru**
 lie-PRS.IND.3SG in Est-lake-ACC.SG and DET.DEF.NOM.SG.M Est-lake-NOM.SG be.PRS.IND.3SG indeed
fiftēne mīl-a **brād.**
 fifteen mile-GEN.PL broad.NOM.SG.M.STR
 ‘And the Vistula leads out of Wendland and leads into the Est Sea (Vistula Lagoon), and the Est Sea is at least 15 miles wide.’
- c. **Ponne cym-eð** **Ilfing** **ēast-an in Ēst-mer-e** **of ðæm**
 then come.PRS-IND.3SG Elblag.NOM.SG east-from in Est-lake-ACC.SG from DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M
mer-e **ðe Truso** **stand-eð** **in stað-e,** **and cum-að** **ūt**
 lake-DAT.SG REL Truso.NOM.SG stand.PRS-IND.3SG in river.shore-DAT.SG and come.PRS-IND.PL out
samod in Ēst-mer-e, **Ilfing** **ēast-an of Ēst-land-e** **and Wīsl-e**
 together in Est-lake-ACC.SG Elblag.NOM.SG east-from from Est-land-DAT.SG and Vistula-NOM.SG
sūð-an of Winod-land-e, **and þonne be-nim-ð** **Wīsl-e** **Ilfing**
 south-from from Wend-land-DAT.SG and then by-take.PRS-IND.3SG Vistula-DAT.SG Elblag.NOM.SG
hire nam-an, **and lig-eð** **of þæm** **mer-e west and**
 3SG.F.GEN name-ACC.SG and lie-PRS.IND.3SG from DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M lake-DAT.SG west.ADV and
norð on sē; **for ðȳ** **hit man hæt**
 north.ADV in sea.ACC.SG for DEM.DIST.INS.SG.N 3SG.N.ACC one.INDF call.PRS.IND.3SG
Wīsl-e-mūð-a.
 Vistula-NOM.SG-river.mouth-NOM.SG
 ‘Then the Elblag (river) comes from the east into the Est Sea from the lake where Truso stands on the shore, and the Elblag from the east from Estland and the Vistula from the south from Wendland come out together into the Est Sea, and then the Elblag deprives the Vistula of its name (i.e. takes the name of the Vistula), and (the combined river) leads from the lake west and north to sea; therefore one calls it the mouth of the Vistula.’
- (10) a. **Þæt** **Ēstland** **is** **swȳð-e** **myċel,** **and þær**
 DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.N Est-land.NOM.SG be.PRS.IND.3SG strong-ADV large.NOM.SG.N.STR and there
bi-ð **swȳð-e** **manig** **burh,** **and on ælc-ere**
 be.HAB-IND.3SG strong-ADV many.NOM.SG.F.STR town.NOM.SG and in every-DAT.SG.F.STR
byrig **bi-ð** **cynincg.**
 town.DAT.SG be.HAB-IND.3SG king.NOM.SG
 ‘That Estland is very large, and there are very many towns, and in each town is a king.’
- b. **And þær bi-ð** **swȳð-e** **myċel** **huniġ** **and fisc-að;** **and**
 and there be.HAB-IND.3SG strong-ADV large.NOM.SG.N.STR honey.NOM.SG and fish-NMLZ.NOM.SG and
sē **cyning** **and þā** **rīc-ost-an** **men**
 DET.DEF.NOM.SG.M king.NOM.SG and DET.DEF.NOM.PL rich-SUP-NOM.PL.WK man.NOM.PL
drinc-að **mȳr-an** **meolc,** **and þā** **un-spēd-ig-an** **and**
 drink.PRS-IND.PL mare-GEN.SG milk.ACC.SG and DET.DEF.NOM.PL un-wealth-ADJ-NOM.PL.WK and
þā **þēow-an** **drinc-að** **medo.**
 DET.DEF.NOM.PL servant-NOM.PL drink.PRS-IND.PL mead.ACC.SG
 ‘And there is very much honey and fishing; and the king and the richest men drink mare’s milk, and the non-wealthy and the servants drink mead.’
- c. **Þær bi-ð** **swȳð-e** **myċel** **ġe-winn** **be-twēon-an him.**
 there be.HAB-IND.3SG strong-ADV large.NOM.SG.N.STR PFX-war.NOM.SG by-two-DAT.PL 3PL.DAT

‘There is much conflict between them.’

- d. **And ne bi-ð ðær n-æniġ ealo ġe-brow-en**
 and NEG be.HAB-IND.3SG there NEG-any.NOM.SG.N.STR ale.NOM.SG PFX-brew-PART.NOM.SG.N.STR
mid Ēst-um, ac þær bi-ð medo ġenōh.
 with Est-DAT.PL but there be.HAB-IND.3SG mead.NOM.SG enough.NOM.SG.M.STR
 ‘And there isn’t any ale brewed among the Ests, but there is sufficient mead.’

- (11) a. **And þær is mid Ēst-um ðēaw, þonne þær bi-ð**
 and there be.PRS.IND.3SG with Est-DAT.PL custom.NOM.SG then there be.HAB-IND.3SG
man dēad, þæt hē lī-ð inn-e
 man.NOM.SG dead.NOM.SG.M.STR COMP 3SG.M.NOM lie-PRS.IND.3SG in-ADV
un-for-bærn-ed mid his māg-um and frēond-um mōnað,
 un-for-burn-PART.NOM.SG.M.STR with 3SG.M.GEN kinsman-DAT.PL and friend-DAT.PL month.ACC.SG
ġe hwīl-um twēgen; and þā kyning-as and þā
 and time-DAT.PL two.ACC.M and DET.DEF.NOM.PL king-NOM.PL and DET.DEF.NOM.PL
ōðr-e hēah-ðung-en-e men swā micl-e lenċġ swā
 other-NOM.PL.M.STR high-flourish-PART-NOM.PL.M.STR man.NOM.PL as large-ADV longer.ADV as
hī mār-an spēd-a habb-að, hwīl-um healf
 3PL.NOM large.COMP-ACC.PL wealth-ACC.PL have-PRS.IND.PL time-DAT.PL half.ACC.SG.N.STR
ġēar þæt hī bēo-ð un-for-bærn-ed; and liċġ-að
 year.ACC.SG COMP 3PL.NOM be.HAB-IND.PL un-for-burn-PART.NOM.PL.M.STR and lie-PRS.IND.PL
b-uf-an eorð-an on hyra hūs-um.
 by-up-from ground-DAT.SG in 3PL.GEN house-DAT.PL

‘And there is a custom with the Ests that when a man dies, he lies inside inside uncremated with his kinsmen and friends for a month, and sometimes two, and the kings and the other high-ranking men, so much longer as they have more wealth, sometimes half a year that they will remain uncremated; and lie above ground in their houses.’

- b. **And eall-e þā hwīl-e þe þæt liċ**
 and all-ACC.SG.F.STR DET.DEF.ACC.SG.F time-ACC.SG REL DET.DEF.NOM.SG.N body.NOM.SG
bi-ð inn-e, þær sċeal bēo-n ġe-drynċ and pleg-a,
 be.HAB-IND.3SG in-ADV there have.to.PRS.IND.3SG be.HAB-INF PFX-drink.NOM.SG and play-NOM.SG
oð ðone dæg þe hī hine for-bærn-að.
 until DET.DEF.ACC.SG.M day.ACC.SG REL 3PL.NOM 3SG.M.ACC for-burn-PRS.IND.PL
 ‘And all the while that the body is inside, there must be be drinking and playing, until the day that they cremate him.’

- c. **Þonne þȳ ylc-an dæg-e þe hī hine tō**
 then DET.DEF.INS.SG.M same-INS.SG.M.WK day-DAT.SG REL 3PL.NOM 3SG.M.ACC to
þæm ād-e ber-an wyll-að, þonne tō-dæl-að hī
 DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M pyre-DAT.SG bear-INF want.PRS-IND.PL then apart-deal-PRS.IND.PL 3PL.NOM
his feoh þæt þær tō lāf-e bi-ð æfter
 3SG.M.GEN property.ACC.SG DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.N there to remainder.DAT.SG be.HAB-IND.3SG after
þæm ġe-drynċ-e and þæm pleg-an on fif oððe syx,
 DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M PFX-drink-DAT.SG and DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M play-DAT.SG in five or six
hwȳl-um on mā, swā swā þæs fēo-s andefn
 time-DAT.PL in large.COMP.ADV as as DET.DEF.GEN.SG.N property-GEN.SG amount.NOM.SG
bi-ð.
 be.HAB-IND.3SG

‘Then the same day that they wish to carry him to the (funeral) pyre, they divide apart his property that remains there after the drinking and the playing into five or six (parts), sometimes into more, as the amount of the property may be.’

- d. **Ā-leċġ-að hit ðonne for-hwæga on ān-re mīl-e þone**
 out-lay-PRS.IND.PL 3SG.N.ACC then for-some in one-DAT.SG.F mile-DAT.SG DET.DEF.ACC.SG.M
mæ-st-an dæl fram þæm tūn-e, þonne oðer-ne,
 large-SUP-ACC.SG.M.WK deal from DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M town-DAT.SG then other-ACC.SG.M.STR

ðonne þæne bridd-an, oþ þæt hyt eall
 then DET.DEF.ACC.SG.M third-ACC.SG.M.WK until COMP 3SG.N.NOM all.NOM.SG.N
 ā-lē-d bi-ð on þære ān-re mīl-e; and
 out-lay-PART.NOM.SG.N.STR be.HAB-IND.3SG in DEM.DIST.DAT.SG.F one-DAT.SG.F mile-DAT.SG and
 s̅ceall bēo-n sē lāe-st-a dæl
 have.to.PRS.IND.3SG be.HAB-INF DET.DEF.NOM.SG.M little-SUP-NOM.SG.M.WK deal.NOM.SG
 n̅yh-st þām tūn-e ðe sē dēad-a
 near-SUP.NOM.SG.M.STR DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M town-DAT.SG REL DET.DEF.NOM.SG.M dead-NOM.SG.M.WK
 man on lī-ð.
 man.NOM.SG in lie-PRS.IND.3SG

‘Then they lay out the largest part of it about one mile from the town, then the second, then the third, until it is all laid within that one mile, and the smallest part shall be nearest to the town that the dead man lived in.’

- (12) a. **Ðonne s̅ceol-on bēo-n ġe-samn-o-d-e eall-e**
 then have.to.PRS-IND.PL be.HAB-INF PFX-gather-THM-PART-NOM.PL.M.STR all-NOM.PL.M.STR
ðā menn ðe swyft-ost-e hors habb-að on
 DET.DEF.NOM.PL man.NOM.PL REL swift-SUP-ACC.PL.N.STR horse.ACC.PL have-PRS.IND.PL in
þām land-e, for-hwæga on fīf mīl-um oððe on syx mīl-um fram
 DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N land-DAT.SG for-some in five mile-DAT.PL or in six mile-DAT.PL from
þām fēo.
 DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N property.DAT.SG
 ‘Then all the men that have the swiftest horses in the land shall be assembled, about five or six miles from the property.’

- b. **Þonne ærn-að h̅y eall-e tō-weard þām fēo;**
 then run-PRS.IND.PL 3PL.NOM all-NOM.PL.M.STR to-ward DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N property.DAT.SG
ðonne cym-eð sē man sē þæt
 then come.PRS-IND.3SG DET.DEF.NOM.SG.M man.NOM.SG DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.M DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N
swyft-ost-e hors haf-að tō þām
 swift-SUP-ACC.SG.N.WK horse.ACC.SG have-PRS.IND.3SG to DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M
ær-est-an dæl-e and tō þām mæ-st-an, and swā
 before-SUP-DAT.SG.M.WK deal-DAT.SG and to DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M large-SUP-DAT.SG.M.WK and as
ælc æfter oðr-um, oþ hit bi-ð eall
 every.NOM.SG.M.STR after other-DAT.SG.M.STR until 3SG.N.NOM be.HAB-IND.3SG all.NOM.SG.N
ġe-num-en; and sē nim-ð þone
 PFX-take-PART.NOM.SG.N.STR and DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.M take-IND.3SG DET.DEF.ACC.SG.M
lāe-st-an dæl sē n̅yh-st þām
 little-SUP-ACC.SG.M.WK deal.ACC.SG DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.M near-SUP.NOM.SG.M.STR DET.DEF.DAT.SG.M
tūn-e þæt feoh ġe-ærn-eð.
 town-DAT.SG DET.DEF.ACC.SG.N property.ACC.SG PFX-run-PRS.IND.3SG
 ‘Then they all run towards the property; then the man who has the swiftest hors comes to the first and the largest part, and so each after the other, until it is all taken, and he who takes the smallest part is he who runs for the property nearest to the town.’

- c. **And þonne rīd-eð ælc hys weġ-es mid ðān**
 and then ride.PRS-IND.3SG every.NOM.SG.M.STR 3SG.M.GEN way-GEN.SG with DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N
fēo, and hyt mōt-an habb-an eall; and for
 property.DAT.SG and 3SG.N.ACC be.allowed-PRS-IND.PL have-INF all.ACC.SG.N and for
ð̅y þær bēo-ð þā swift-an hors
 DEM.DIST.INS.SG.N there be.HAB-IND.PL DET.DEF.NOM.PL swift-NOM.PL.N.WK horse.NOM.PL
un-ġe-fōg-e d̅yr-e.
 un-PFX-joining-ADV dear-NOM.PL.N.STR
 ‘And then each rides on his way with the property, and can have it all; and therefore swift horses are immensely valuable there.’
- d. **And þonne hys ġe-strēon bēo-ð þus eall ā-spend-ed,**
 and then 3SG.M.GEN PFX-treasure be.HAB-IND.PL thus all.NOM.PL.N out-spend-PART.NOM.PL.N.STR

þonne byr-ð man hine út and for-bærn-eð mid his
 then bear-PRS.IND.3SG one.INDF 3SG.M.ACC out and for-burn-PRS.IND.3SG with 3SG.M.GEN
 wæpn-um and hrægl-e.
 weapon-DAT.PL and clothing-DAT.SG

‘And when his property is thus all spent, then one carries him out and cremates (him) with his weapons and clothing.’

- e. And swið-ost eall-e hys spēd-a hȳ for-spend-að mid
 and strong-SUP.ADV all-ACC.PL.F 3SG.M.GEN wealth-ACC.PL 3PL.NOM for-spend-PRS.IND.PL with
 þān lang-an leger-e þæs dēad-an
 DET.DEF.DAT.SG.N long-DAT.SG.N.WK lying-DAT.SG DET.DEF.GEN.SG.M dead-GEN.SG.M.WK
 mann-es inn-e, and þæs þe hȳ be þāem weg-um
 man-GEN.SG in-ADV and DEM.DIST.GEN.SG.N REL 3PL.NOM by DET.DEF.DAT.PL way-DAT.PL
 ā-lecġ-að, þe ðā fremd-an tō ærn-að and nim-að.
 out-lay-PRS.IND.PL REL DET.DEF.NOM.PL stranger-NOM.PL to run-PRS.IND.PL and take-IND.PL

‘And most (commonly) they spend away all his wealth with the long lying of the dead man inside, and what they lay out on the roads, which the strangers run to and take (away).’

- (13) a. And þæt is mid Ēst-um þēaw þæt þær
 and DEM.DIST.NOM.SG.N be.PRS.IND.3SG with Est-DAT.PL custom.NOM.SG COMP there
 sċeal ælc-es ġe-ðēod-es man bēo-n
 have.to.PRS.IND.3SG every-GEN.SG.N.STR PFX-nation-GEN.SG man.NOM.SG be.HAB-INF
 for-bærn-ed; and ġyf þār man ān bān find-eð
 for-burn-PART.NOM.SG.M.STR and if there one.INDF one.ACC.SG.N bone.ACC.SG find.PRS.IND.3SG
 un-for-bærn-ed, hī hit sċeol-an micl-um
 un-for-burn-PART.ACC.SG.N.STR 3PL.NOM 3SG.N.ACC have.to.PRS.IND.PL large-DAT.SG.N.STR
 ġe-bēt-an.
 PFX-atone.for-INF

‘And it is a custom with the Ests that there men of every tribe must be cremated; and if there one finds a single bone uncremated, they must atone for it greatly.’

- b. And þær is mid Ēst-um ān mægð þæt hī
 and there be.PRS.IND.3SG with Est-DAT.PL one.NOM.SG.F power.NOM.SG COMP 3PL.NOM
 mag-on ċyl-e ġe-wyrċ-an; and þȳ þær liċġ-að
 can.PRS.IND.PL cold-ACC.SG PFX-make-INF and DEM.DIST.INS.SG.N there lie-PRS.IND.PL
 þā dēad-an men swā lang-e and ne fūl-i-að, þæt
 DET.DEF.NOM.PL dead-NOM.PL.WK man-NOM.PL as long-ADV and NEG foul-THM-PRS.IND.PL COMP
 hȳ wyrċ-að þone ċyl-e hine on.
 3PL.NOM make-PRS.IND.PL DET.DEF.ACC.SG.M cold-ACC.SG 3SG.M.ACC in

‘And there is among the Ests a power such that they can make coldness; and therefore the dead men lie there so long and do not decay, because they work the cold onto him.’

- c. And þēah man ā-sett-e twēgen fætels-as full eal-að
 and though one.INDF out-set-PRS.SJV.SG two.ACC.M vessel-ACC.PL full.ACC.PL.M.STR ale-GEN.SG
 oððe wæter-es, hȳ ġe-dō-ð þæt oþer bi-ð
 or water-GEN.SG 3PL.NOM PFX-do-PRS.IND.PL COMP other.NOM.SG.M.STR be.HAB-IND.3SG
 ofer-fror-en, sam hit sȳ sumor sam winter.
 over-freeze-PART.NOM.SG.M.STR same 3SG.N.NOM be.PRS.SJV.SG summer.NOM.SG same winter.NOM.SG

‘And if one sets out two vessels² full of ale or water, they make it such that either will be frozen over, whether it be summer or winter.’

²Some versions of the text have the form *fætels* instead of *fætelsas*. Bosworth Toller lists both forms as possible NOM/ACC.PL forms.

2 Use of different resources

- Text, paragraph structure, and punctuation: Baker (n.d.)
- Text, palatalization marking: Fulk (2020)
- Text: <http://www.oegrammar.ca/texts/voyage-of-ohthere/>
- Resolving differences between texts in palatalization and vowel-length marking: Wiktionary
- Text and translation: <https://vikingraiders.yolasite.com/resources/Ohthere-dual.pdf>
- Text: https://archive.org/details/rcin.org.pl.WA51_92790_PAN37315-r1855_Description-Europe_71615/page/n9/mode/2up
- Translation of words: Wiktionary, Bosworth Toller, <https://www.oldenglishaerobics.net/ohthere.php>

3 Glossing abbreviations

1 = 1st person	F = feminine gender	PASS = passive voice
2 = 2nd person	GEN = genitive case	PFX = prefix
3 = 3rd person	HAB = habitual	PL = plural
ACC = accusative case	IMP = imperative mood	POSS = possessive
ADJ = adjective	IND = indicative mood	PRS = present tense
ADV = adverb	INDF = indefinite	PROX = proximate
AGT = agent	INF = infinitive	PST = past tense
CMP = comparative	INS = instrumental case	REL = relativizer
COMP = complementizer	M = masculine gender	SG = singular
DAT = dative case	NEG = negative	SJV = subjunctive mood
DEF = definite	N = neuter gender	STR = strong declension (indef.)
DEM = demonstrative	NMLZ - nominalizer	SUP = superlative
DET = determiner	NOM = nominative case	THM = theme vowel
DIST = distal	PART = participle	WK = weak declension (def.)

References

- Baker, Peter S. N.d. Ohthere and Wulfstan. Old English Aerobics. <https://www.oldenglishaerobics.net/ohthere.php>.
- Fulk, Robert Dennis. 2020. *An introductory grammar of old english: With an anthology of readings* (Medieval and Renaissance Texts and Studies 463). Tempe, AZ: Arizona Center for Medieval & Renaissance Studies.